



SCHOLARSHIP PROGRAM RESOURCE PACKET

Actuarial Exam Resource Guide

A practical guide for WAOW scholarship recipients and actuarial candidates.

Use this packet to find official exam information, free and paid study materials, scholarship opportunities, exam-day resources, and study planning tips.

Living resource note

This PDF is designed to be paired with a live online resource hub so WAOW can add new resources over time without redistributing the full packet.

Live Resource Hub: [\[insert URL once published\]](#)

Last updated: 6/21/2026

1 Welcome and how to use this guide

Congratulations on being selected as a Women Actuaries of the West scholarship recipient. We created this guide to help you navigate the actuarial exam pathway, identify reliable study tools, and connect with resources that can support your progress.

Important: This guide is informational and is not a substitute for official exam guidance. Always confirm current requirements, syllabi, registration deadlines, rules, fees, and exam-day procedures directly with the SOA or the applicable exam administrator.

QUICK START

Suggested first steps

-  Confirm the correct exam, syllabus, registration window, and testing format.
-  Choose one primary study resource and use others as supplements.
-  Build a study calendar that includes learning, practice, and review time.
-  Practice under timed conditions before exam day.
-  Ask for support early - from mentors, peers, professors, or WAOW connections.

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Official exam information

Start with official sources when making decisions about exam requirements, registration, syllabi, fees, exam rules, and candidate guidance.

OFFICIAL

SOA Education and Exam Information

Exam information including syllabi, guides and seminars, FAQs, registration, discounts, and reimbursement opportunities.

OPEN RESOURCE

soa.org/education/general-info/default/

OVERVIEW

Be An Actuary - Actuarial Exams

Exam background, tips and tricks, sample problems, and financial support opportunities for aspiring actuaries.

OPEN RESOURCE

beanactuary.org/actuarial-exams/

PRACTICE

SOA Past Exams and Solutions

Past exams and solutions where available. Note: Exams P, FM, FAM, and SRM are not generally included among released SOA exams; check the SOA page for the current list.

OPEN RESOURCE

soa.org/education/exam-req/syllabus-study-materials/edu-multiple-choice-exam/

SAMPLES

SOA Sample Exams

Official SOA sample exams and sample questions. Use these to understand exam style and topic coverage.

OPEN RESOURCE

soa.org/education/exam-req/syllabus-study-materials/edu-exam-p-online-sample/

Tip: Before buying materials or building a study plan, download the official syllabus and compare each study resource against the current learning objectives.

Scholarships, reimbursement, and exam day

Financial support and exam-day preparation can make a meaningful difference. Use these resources early, especially before registering for an exam or scheduling a test appointment.

FINANCIAL SUPPORT

SOA Scholarships and Reimbursement Programs

Scholarship and reimbursement programs for actuarial candidates, including programs that may help offset exam-related costs.

OPEN RESOURCE

soa.org/future-actuaries/scholarships-and-reimbursements/

EXAM DAY

SOA Exam Day Information

Exam-day information including what to expect with Prometric, testing procedures, allowed items, identification, timing, and logistics.

OPEN RESOURCE

soa.org/education/general-info/exam-resources/exam-day-information/

WAOW

WAOW Scholarship Program

WAOW supports future actuaries through exam scholarships and community-building resources. Follow WAOW on LinkedIn for announcements, future scholarship cycles, and updates.

WAOW LinkedIn: [CLICK HERE](#)

LIVE HUB

Use the living resource link

The online hub should be treated as the most current version of this packet. WAOW can add resources, update descriptions, and retire outdated links over time.

Resource Hub: [insert URL once published]

Before exam day: Check your appointment confirmation, test center location, accepted identification, calculator rules, arrival time, and food or break policies. Do not wait until the night before.

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Free study resources

Free resources can be very helpful, especially when used to supplement a primary study plan. Because free resources may vary in completeness or currency, compare them against the official syllabus.

The Actuarial Nexus

Free practice questions, course materials, flashcards, and formula sheets.

Open resource

theactuarialnexus.com/docs/getting-started/free

P, FM, SRM, FAM

The Infinite Actuary - Free

Free Exam P and FM courses. **Open resource**

theinfiniteactuary.com/free

P, FM

Stochiki

Exam guides compiled by an individual and organized as actuarial science wiki content. **Open resource**

stochiki.com/wiki/Category:Actuarial_Science

P, FM, FAM, ASTAM

YouTube - Exam P Exercises

Video explanations of mostly Exam P exercises. **Open playlist**

youtube.com/playlist?list=PLmichdCH6hb4gdFNa4yDM_xbLu1-Tbj8M

Exam P

YouTube - Exam FM Concepts

Video explanations of mostly Exam FM concepts. **Open playlist**

youtube.com/playlist?list=PLdYaKZKg4e_PTz1yvaUbuKDgTECem7zu3

Exam FM

How to use free resources: Use them to reinforce topics, get additional explanations, or build extra practice. Avoid using too many sources at once, which can make studying feel scattered.

Paid study resources

Paid study resources can provide structure, practice questions, video instruction, analytics, or complete study plans. Before purchasing, confirm the resource covers your current exam syllabus and learning style.

PAID COURSE

Coaching Actuaries

Commercial exam-preparation platform commonly used by candidates for preliminary actuarial exams.

OPEN RESOURCE

coachingactuaries.com

PAID COURSE

ACTEX Learning

Study manuals, courses, and exam-preparation materials. A student recently recommended ACTEX for PA and SRM.

OPEN RESOURCE

actexlearning.com

PAID SEMINAR

MATE Seminars

Seminars and materials focused on select FSA-level exams.

OPEN RESOURCE

mateseminars.com

BEFORE YOU BUY

Questions to ask

-  Does this resource align with the current syllabus?
-  Does it match how I learn best - reading, videos, practice, or coaching?
-  How long will I have access?
-  Are there student discounts, scholarships, or employer reimbursements?

STUDY SETUP

One primary source is usually enough

Many candidates succeed by using one main course or manual, then supplementing with additional questions or explanations only where needed.

Too many resources can create more confusion than confidence.

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Study strategy and progress tracking

Every exam and every candidate is different, but successful study plans usually include concept learning, repeated practice, timed exams, and careful review of mistakes.

Phase 1: Orient

Confirm syllabus, registration deadlines, exam format, and materials. Build a calendar with weekly targets.

Phase 2: Learn

Work through the core material. Take notes on formulas, common traps, and concepts that need repetition.

Phase 3: Practice

Increase the volume of practice questions and begin working under light time pressure.

Phase 4: Simulate

Complete timed practice exams, review misses, and focus the final weeks on weak areas and exam-day readiness.

Mindset: Failing an actuarial exam is common and does not define your future success. Persistence, reflection, and adjustment are part of the process.

Mistake review tracker

Topic or problem type	What went wrong?	Next action

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Network, support, and next steps

Technical preparation is only one part of becoming an actuary. Community, mentorship, and professional connections can help you stay motivated, discover opportunities, and learn from others who have navigated the same path.

ABOUT WAOW

Women Actuaries of the West

WAOW is a grassroots networking organization based in Utah. It was formed to connect and empower women and allies of all backgrounds, races, ethnicities, and life circumstances to be successful in the actuarial profession.

WAOW hosts monthly networking lunches in Utah and supports actuarial candidates through resources, community, and scholarship opportunities.

Add QR
code for
live
resource
hub

STAY CONNECTED

Follow and share

Follow Women Actuaries of the West on LinkedIn to read the Impact Report, learn about future scholarship cycles, and hear about new resources and announcements.

WAOW LinkedIn: [insert URL]

Contact or resource suggestions: [insert email or form link]

FOR RECIPIENTS

Ways to use your network

-  Ask an actuary about their study strategy and exam path.
-  Find a peer or mentor for accountability.
-  Share what resources work well so WAOW can improve this guide.

FINAL NOTE

You are not alone

The exam process can be challenging, but it is also a place where community matters. Use this guide, ask questions, and keep going.

WAOW is cheering you on.